

# Position Paper

## What are position papers?

The purpose of the position paper is to assist delegates in assembling their research into an organized policy statement and ensure that debate in committees is highly substantive. Individual position papers are a crucial part of the preparation process, and further information about their format and content is provided in this section.

In each committee Background Paper, the Director has presented issues on each topic generally as it pertains to individual delegations specifically. The Research and Preparation Questions found at the end of the topic papers in each Background Paper have been especially formulated to lead the delegates in a logical progression through the topic and position paper. It is important that delegates directly answer these research questions.

## A good position paper will:

- Clearly outline the country's policies on the topics.
- Identify the factors contributing to a country's positions.
- Refer to domestic and international documents and correctly cite the sources.
- Deal with the in-depth issues of the topic areas as well as the overt topic issues.
- Provide suggestions of solutions that address the problem areas.

- **Answer all Research and Preparation Questions posed in the background Guides.**

**In addition, the position papers should be concise, accurate, and well written. The staff looks for the demonstration of the following skills in evaluating the papers:**

- **Original and critical thinking**
- **True understanding of the dynamics of your country**
- **Functional and applied knowledge of the topics.**

**Please note that under no circumstances will plagiarism of any portion of position papers be tolerated! Plagiarism is defined as the usage of material from other sources without appropriate citation. Plagiarism includes both word-for-word borrowing of text and material and paraphrasing of material without citation. All material acquired from existing sources, including text quotations, charts, graphs, diagrams, and data must be cited.**

## **How to write a position paper**

**It is important to recognize that the amount of information available for use in your position paper will vary according to the size, level of development, and age of your country. Your committee's topic will also affect the amount and type of research you will be able to find. Do not be discouraged by the limitations of your resources.**

# Position Paper Format

**Name:**

**Committee:**

**Topic:**

**Country: (Country's Flag in color)**

**Grade and Group:**

**Due Date:**

**School:**



## **FORMAT:**

- Arial 12
- Justified Paragraphs
- 1.5 Line Spacing

### **I. Introduction (More than 8 lines)**

- a) Statement of the issue and the background.
- b) Statement of your country's position on the topic.

### **II. Body ( More than 10 lines)**

- a) Your country's actions concerning the topic.
- b) Supported evidence of facts
- c) United Nations actions and agreements regarding the topic.

### **III. Proposed actions and solutions (More than 10 lines)**

- a) Your country's suggestions as actions to be implemented.
- b) Proposed solutions.

### **IV. Bibliography ( At least five references in APA format)**

# Position Paper Example

Jimena Lozano

Mexico

UNODC

Avoiding the Production of  
Synthetic Drugs

Pan American School

8B

October 23, 2023



The synthetic drugs are made from different chemical structures instead of natural resources. The effect of the synthetic drugs is that it affects the nervous system. The production of synthetic drugs has increased in the last years due to all the development in modern chemical and pharmaceutical manufacturers, also due to all the modern discoveries in both industries in recent years, as a result of this, the sale and illegal consumption of synthetic drugs has increased in recent years, the impact of the consequences of the consumption and sale of these has damage not only our present generation, but also unfortunately it has also damage our younger generations, causing a lot of deaths in the recent years, and without even mentioning the pollution that the manufacture of these cause. The drugs that have been affecting more are the fentanyl, cocaine, methamphetamine, and tramadol. Since the 1970s, in Mexico, the number of drug trafficking has increased, especially in the northern part of the country. In Mexico it was more normal to cultivate drugs, but since the United States legalized the consumption of marijuana, drug trafficking groups have been selling and producing more synthetic drugs, causing a lot of deaths not only in Mexico, but also in other countries. Another consequence of this is that in recent years there has also been an increase of illegal laboratories to produce synthetic drugs. It is known the process of the production of synthetic drugs and the role of the cartels in Mexico. First, Asian countries import the chemical materials to Mexico, then illegal laboratories produce the drugs and then export them to other, normally neighboring countries. In a recent meeting with the

United States and Canada, it was revealed that during the government of the current president, Mexico has destroyed 1,788 illegal laboratories. And also the Mexican government has also revealed that they are going to create a new commission to face the issue.

Analyzing the situation not only in the country of my delegation but also globally, my delegation would like to propose the following solutions: 1) completely disable all illegal laboratories internationally, to find the laboratories we can begin an international investigation to find the location, after finding the locations my delegation suggest to also investigate if the laboratory has made any harm to the environment. 2) Increase safety in sea and air routes, also on roads, especially in the north and south of Mexico. 3) Something that concerns my delegation is the fact that these days it has been recorded that young people today are also consuming synthetic drugs. My delegation believes that education is also key so that young people can be aware of the consequences of their consumption. The good thing is that it can be used for both synthetic drugs and natural drugs. My delegation believes that we can also reach to people who were affected by the drugs and suffer it in first person the consequences of these, so they can give their testimony and warn teenagers.

#### References:

1) What is a synthetic drug? (n.d.b). [Video]

<https://www.drugfreeworld.org/drugfacts/synthetic.html>

2) Psycom /(by: Kathleen Smith)/ May 14, 2021/The dangers of synthetic drugs

<https://www.psychom.net/the-dangers-of-synthetic-drugs>

3) UNODC/ The synthetic drug phenomenon/ (n.d)

[https://www.unodc.org/res/WDR-2023/WDR23\\_B3\\_CH1\\_Synthetic\\_drugs.pdf](https://www.unodc.org/res/WDR-2023/WDR23_B3_CH1_Synthetic_drugs.pdf)

4) De la Defensa Nacional, SEDENA (n.d.) Las drogas tradicionales y sintéticas en México.

<https://www.gob.mx/sedena/prensa/las-drogas-tradicionales-y-sinteticas-en-mexico>

o

5) Capital 21/ Reunión Trilateral: México ha destruido mil 788 laboratorios de drogas sintéticas/ July 26, 2023

<https://www.capital21.cdmx.gob.mx/noticias/?p=44958>